

20-Minute Voiceover Script

THE CHURCH — Lesson 5

New Zealand Male Accent | Ready-to-Record Version

New Zealand Male Accent & Delivery Guide

Accent notes (keep it warm and natural, not exaggerated):

- Light non-rhotic 'r' — soften or drop the 'r' at the end of words (church, Peter, over, builder, scripture).
- Gentle rising lilt on some statements — makes teaching feel conversational and engaging.
- "Jesus" → soft "Jee-zus" (the 'z' is gentle).
- "Pentecost" → stress on first syllable: **PEN**-ti-cost.
- "Lesson" and "church" have a slightly flatter, broader vowel sound than American English.
- Overall tone: warm, steady, thoughtful teacher — like a kind local pastor or Bible study leader.

Recording tips:

- Speak at a measured, clear pace (~140–150 words per minute).
 - Pause naturally after Scripture quotes and at [pause] cues.
 - Emphasise words in **bold** slightly — don't overdo it.
 - Smile slightly while speaking — it warms the voice even on audio.
 - Total target: ~20 minutes including natural pauses.
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[Opening – ~1.5 min] | [Warm, welcoming tone]

"Good morning, friends. Today we're studying Lesson 5: **The Church**.

The Bible doesn't give us a building or a denomination name. Instead, it reveals what the church *is* — who built it, when and where it began, who owns it, what it's called, how it's organized, how it worships, what work it does, and how we become members.

Our lesson page organizes everything around eight key headings with supporting Scriptures. Let's walk through them together. Open your Bibles and follow along."

[short pause]

[1. BUILDER – ~2 min] | [Clear and steady]

BUILDER

"First, the **BUILDER**. Matthew 16:18 —

'And I tell you that you are Peter, and on this rock I will build my church, and the gates of Hades will not overcome it.'

[pause 1–2 sec after the quote]

This comes right after Peter's confession in Matthew 16:13-18. Jesus asks the disciples who people say He is. Peter answers, 'You are the Messiah, the Son of the living God.' Jesus replies that this truth came from the Father in heaven.

Then He says, 'You are Peter (*Petros* — a stone) and on this rock (*petra* — bedrock) I will build my church.'

The church is built on the solid rock of the confession that Jesus is the Christ, the Son of the living God — and ultimately on Christ Himself. Jesus is both the Builder and the Foundation. The church belongs to Him, and not even the gates of Hades can prevail against it.

Key points from our lesson:

1. Peter's confession.
2. Jesus identifies it as coming from God.
3. Jesus announces He will build His church upon that rock.

Jesus is the Builder."

[short pause]

[2. BEGINNING TIME AND PLACE – ~2 min]

BEGINNING — Time and Place

“Next, the **BEGINNING — Time and Place**.

Time: ‘In the last days...’ — the Day of Pentecost.

Isaiah 2:2-3 prophesied:

‘In the last days the mountain of the LORD’s temple will be established as the highest of the mountains... The law will go out from Zion, the word of the LORD from Jerusalem.’

[pause 1–2 sec]

This was fulfilled on the Day of Pentecost in Acts 2. The Holy Spirit came with power (Acts 2:1-4), Peter preached the first gospel message, and he quoted Joel: ‘In the last days, God says, I will pour out my Spirit on all people’ (Acts 2:16-17). About 3,000 people were baptized and added that day (Acts 2:41), and the Lord kept adding daily those who were being saved (Acts 2:47).

Place: ‘...out of Zion’ — Jerusalem.

Exactly as Isaiah foretold and as Jesus had instructed the apostles to wait in Jerusalem (Acts 1:4,8). The church began in Jerusalem on Pentecost, just as prophesied.”

[short pause]

[3. OWNER AND HEAD – ~2 min] | [Slightly warmer tone]

OWNER AND HEAD

“Now, **OWNER AND HEAD**.

Owner: Jesus calls it ‘My church’ (Matthew 16:18). Acts 20:28 tells the elders:

‘Be shepherds of the church of God, which he bought with his own blood.’

[pause]

It is Jesus’ body — ‘the church, which is his body’ (Ephesians 1:22-23; 1 Corinthians 12:27).

Head: Jesus has all authority (Matthew 28:18). God ‘appointed him to be head over everything for the church’ (Ephesians 1:22-23). Colossians 1:18 says, ‘And he is the head of the body, the church... so that in everything he might have the supremacy.’

Jesus purchased the church with His blood. He is its owner and its head. He has first place in all things.”

[4. DESIGNATIONS – ~2 min]

DESIGNATIONS

“**DESIGNATIONS** — what the Bible calls the church and its members.

The Individual:

We are called *disciples*, *Christians* (Acts 11:26), *saints*, and *children of God* (Galatians 3:26; 1 Corinthians 1:2).

The Group:

The Bible uses many beautiful names:

- The church of God / of Christ
- The body of Christ (1 Corinthians 12:27)
- The kingdom of Christ
- The house of God (1 Timothy 3:15)

No single man-made name captures it all. These designations describe our relationship to Christ and to one another. We are family, a body, a kingdom, and God’s household.”

[5. ORGANIZATION – ~2 min] | [Steady, clear]

ORGANIZATION

“**ORGANIZATION.** Christ is the head (Ephesians 1:22-23).

Locally, the New Testament shows simple, Spirit-led organization:

- Philippians 1:1 — letters addressed ‘together with the overseers and deacons.’
- Acts 14:23 — Paul and Barnabas ‘appointed elders in every church.’
- Acts 20:17,28 — Paul met with the elders of the Ephesian church and told them the Holy Spirit had made them overseers (shepherds/pastors) to care for the flock.

Each congregation is autonomous — self-governing under Christ — with qualified elders (overseers) and deacons serving. There is no earthly headquarters or central hierarchy beyond Christ and His word in the New Testament pattern. The organization is simple, relational, and focused on shepherding God’s people.”

[short pause]

[6. WORSHIP – ~3 min] | [Warm and reverent]

WORSHIP

“**WORSHIP.** How does the church worship?

John 4:24 — ‘God is spirit, and his worshipers must worship in the Spirit and in truth.’

[pause 1–2 sec]

The early church met on the first day of the week (Acts 20:7) to break bread — the Lord’s Supper. Jesus Himself instituted it:

‘This is my body... This cup is the new covenant in my blood; do this in remembrance of me’ (1 Corinthians 11:23-26).

[pause]

They also sang and prayed with both spirit *and* understanding (1 Corinthians 14:15), taught the word, and gave generously.

Worship is not about ritual or entertainment. It is heartfelt, Spirit-led, and grounded in truth — centered on remembering Jesus’ death and resurrection. The Lord’s Supper, in particular, keeps the cross at the center every first day of the week.”

[7. WORK – ~1.5 min]

WORK

“**WORK.** What is the church’s work?

1 Timothy 3:15 calls the church ‘the pillar and foundation of the truth.’ We uphold, proclaim, and defend the gospel.

James 1:27 adds:

‘Religion that God our Father accepts as pure and faultless is this: to look after orphans and widows in their distress and to keep oneself from being polluted by the world.’

[pause]

The church’s work is to stand for truth and to show practical love — caring for the vulnerable while living holy lives. It is both doctrinal and compassionate.”

[8. MEMBERSHIP – ~2 min] | [Clear and direct]

MEMBERSHIP

“Finally, **MEMBERSHIP** — how do we become part of the church?

On the Day of Pentecost, Peter answered that very question:

‘Repent and be baptized, every one of you, in the name of Jesus Christ for the forgiveness of your sins. And you will receive the gift of the Holy Spirit’ (Acts 2:38).

[pause 1–2 sec]

Those who accepted the message were baptized, and about three thousand were added that day (Acts 2:41). ‘And the Lord added to their number daily those who were being saved’ (Acts 2:47).

Ephesians 5:23,25 reminds us that Christ is the head of the church and that He ‘loved the church and gave himself up for her.’

Membership in Christ’s church is not by joining a human organization. It happens when a person, through faith, repents, is baptized into Christ for the forgiveness of sins, and is added by the Lord Himself to His body.”

[Conclusion & Application – ~2 min] | [Warm, encouraging close]

Conclusion & Application

“Let’s summarize what we’ve seen:

- **Builder:** Jesus, on the rock of Peter’s confession that He is the Christ.
- **Beginning:** Pentecost, Jerusalem, in the last days — exactly as prophesied.
- **Owner & Head:** Jesus, who bought us with His blood and has all authority.
- **Designations:** Many beautiful names — body, kingdom, household, Christians, saints.
- **Organization:** Simple — Christ as head, local elders and deacons serving.
- **Worship:** In spirit and truth, centered on the Lord’s Supper every first day.
- **Work:** Uphold truth and care for the vulnerable.
- **Membership:** The saved are added by the Lord through obedient faith and baptism.

The church is not a building or a denomination. It is the people who belong to Jesus — purchased by His blood, led by Him, worshiping Him, working for Him, and living as His body.

Personal reflection questions (take 30–60 seconds of silence or discuss briefly):

1. Have I been added to the Lord’s church by obeying the gospel?
2. Am I worshiping and working as the New Testament describes?
3. How can I better honor Christ as the head of His church this week?

Let’s close with a word of prayer and a challenge to live as members of Christ’s body — the church He built, bought, and leads.”

[End with a gentle pause, then close with prayer if recording for a class.]

End of voiceover script. Target delivery time: ~20 minutes with natural pauses.

Lesson 5 – The Church | New Zealand Male Voiceover Script | Wording kept exact from original lesson